

Week 14: Middleware & Routing in Express

1. Built-in Middleware (*express.json*, *express.static*)

Middleware is an important part of Express.js that helps process requests before they reach route handlers. Built-in middleware like `express.json()` is used to parse incoming JSON data from client requests. `express.static()` is used to serve static files such as HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and images. These middleware functions improve server functionality and simplify request handling.

2. Custom Middleware

Custom middleware is created by developers to handle specific tasks such as logging requests, authentication checks, or error handling. It runs between the client request and the final response. Custom middleware makes code reusable and improves maintainability in larger applications.

3. Route Parameters, Query Strings

Route parameters allow dynamic values in URLs, such as product IDs or usernames. Query strings are used to send additional data in the URL for filtering, sorting, or searching. Both concepts are useful for creating flexible and dynamic APIs.

4. Handling *GET*, *POST*, *PUT*, *DELETE*

These are common HTTP methods used in RESTful APIs. `GET` retrieves data, `POST` creates new data, `PUT` updates existing data, and `DELETE` removes data. Learning these methods is essential for building complete backend services.

Conclusion

This week focused on middleware and routing in Express.js. By learning built-in middleware, custom middleware, route parameters, query strings, and HTTP methods, backend request handling became more efficient and organized.